

Ethics

Hebrew course name: Etika

Lecturer: Dr. David Shtetter | 2 credit points

Course description

An examination of ethical reasoning and its application to professional practice in computing. Covers consequentialism, deontology, virtue ethics, privacy, algorithmic fairness, and professional codes of conduct.

Grading

Final essay: 50% of the course grade.

Two short position papers: 30% of the course grade, 15% each.

Class participation: 20% of the course grade.

There is no written examination in this course.

Late submission policy

Three points are deducted for each day a paper is submitted late. Papers are not accepted more than five days after the deadline. The final essay deadline is firm and no extension is given.

Prerequisites

There are no prerequisites for this course. It is open to students from all departments and all years.

Attendance

Attendance at 85% of sessions is required. Because the class participation component depends on discussion, absence directly reduces that portion of the grade.

Required reading

Practical Ethics by Peter Singer, third edition.

Weapons of Math Destruction by Cathy O'Neil.

The ACM Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct, 2018 revision.

Academic integrity

All written work must be the student's own. Use of generative AI tools must be disclosed in an appendix stating which tool was used and for what purpose. Undisclosed use is treated as plagiarism.